Q+A

A BEAUTIFUL LIFE

In her new book The Art of Being Fabulous, ***Shalini Passi*** *moves beyond glamour to outline a philosophy rooted in discipline and intention*



Q. In *The Art of Being Fabulous*, you redefine fabulousness as discipline rather than surface glamour. When did you realise that?

After I married at 20, I entered a Delhi social world where appearances signalled status. I had to create a persona to survive. But internally, I remained the same. That was when I understood identity begins within. In art, you master technique before breaking the rules. I perfected the external performance. Now I am breaking it.

Q. The book speaks about boundaries and using privilege intentionally. Was that difficult in a culture that equates excess with success?

Privilege is about responsibility. I try to encourage people to collect art and give meaningfully. When I speak to women across the country, they say I inspire them. In truth, I receive energy from them. Intentionality does not drain you. It strengthens you.

Q. You once feared the camera. What changed?

Before 2018, I avoided photographs and public speaking. I would freeze. For me, growth comes from confronting fear. So I stepped in front of the camera deliberately. It was challenging, and that excited me.

Q. How do you think about visibility versus value in the art world?

Artists must be sustained for the ecosystem to survive. We invest in Indian art and support emerging voices. Visibility matters, but value comes from long term commitment.

—with Nikhil Sardana

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